

copy all of the associated samples into one directory and save a copy of the *.flp file as well. That way you will be able to work on the song days, weeks, or even months later without having to relocate all of your samples. Backup your *.flp files often, so that you can track changes and modifications to subsequent versions of the file.

Enter useful information about the song (ideas for changes, etc) into the Song Info dialog box (found in the Options menu).



Add effects, twist sounds and layer the samples in FruityLoops

point. Often, this will add a slight metallic quality to the sound and give it a bit more edge. Even better, try detuning one of the loops slightly; the bigger the detune, the more out of time the loops get. This will produce some interesting flanging effects.

ReBirth

ReBirth is an excellent software for emulation of drum and bass patterns. It is a software reincarnation of classic analogue hardware synthesizers. The panel looks like two Roland TB-303 bassline synthesizers and the Roland TR-808 and TR-909 rhythm machines

PCF: The heart of ReBirth
Pattern Controlled Filter (PCF) is basically a filter module consisting of 54 preset patterns, a two-pole filter and four control parameters. This is the unit that generates the basic sound loop upon which you can add effects and change various parameters that decide what the eventual loop sounds like. What this effectively means is that you have a little bag of tricks that can transform a dated synthesizer into a more sophisticated animal. Along with the PCF, the sound can be altered using the distortion and delay FX in ReBirth.

Here's how you can use the PCF filter to create your own track in ReBirth:

Step 1: To create a single note



on one of the panels in pattern mode, click on one of the keys in this panel.

Step 2: Set the Tune knob on the 303 panel to the 12 o'clock position. For a rich bass sound set Cutoff to the 7 o'clock position, Resonance to the 4 o'clock position and Envelope Modulation to 3 o'clock. Decay should be set high so that the note characteristics don't fade too quickly. Play around with these settings for different effects.

Step 3: Press Play and listen to your one-bar bass note. Press the PCF button on the 303 panel. The green light will come on and you will notice a change in the sound. Lower the tempo so that you can hear the notes clearly.

Step 4: Flick through the various preset patterns by pressing the up and down keys next to the number on the PCF panel. With ReBirth playing, add some delay to your sound by turning the Delay knob on the 303 panel to 2 o'clock. You can edit the

effect on the delay panel if you want.

Step 5: Audition some of the sweeping PCF patterns (12-17) and listen to how far your one-note ReBirth pattern has come. It's incredible what you can do with the synthesizer.

Step 6: Toggle to Song Mode and set a loop of eight bars beginning at bar 1. Choose Initialize Loop From Pattern Mode on the Edit menu. Make sure the loop is switched on and playing. You will now hear an eight-bar loop of the sound you created in Pattern Mode.

Step 7: By selecting the Record button and pressing Play, you can record the changes you make to the PCF parameters in real time into your track. Move the PCF sliders around to create your own filter patterns on top of the PCF presets.

Feel free to play around with all the knobs, now that you know the basics. You never know what you can come up with. ■

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Synchronising loops

If you need to synchronise loops of different tempos, you'll have to stretch some of them. Divide the tempo of the one you're stretching by the target tempo to get the ratio by which you need to change the length of the loop.

Using multiple tracks

Another interesting thing you can do with multiple tracks is grabbing a couple of identical drum loops and triggering them at exactly the same



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